

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1029

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Love's Way Church of Lebanon on the grand opening of its new location.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should recognize those venerable religious institutions and their congregations who, through their unflagging capacity for love, dedication of spirit, and faith in God, strive to enrich the lives of people in their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such dynamic community of faith is that of Love's Way Church in Lebanon, which is celebrating the grand opening of a new location on May 3, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Love's Way Church was founded by Bob and Peggy Evans, who also founded Joseph's Storehouse in 1999, and held its first service as Love's Way Community Church on March 22, 2005, in a conference room at Comfort Suites with twenty people in attendance; and

WHEREAS, a room at Joseph's Storehouse was opened and cleaned to create a Chapel for Love's Way Church in April 2005; as the congregation grew, the room had to be enlarged to hold the swelling numbers; and

WHEREAS, after serving as pastor for nine years, Bob Evans retired on January 5, 2014; during this time, the church and the board of elders fasted and prayed for God to send someone with a passion and vision to lead this young church into the purpose and destiny that God had for them; and

WHEREAS, Pastor Johan and Elize McGregor, originally from South Africa, had been ministering and carrying out the gospel of Jesus Christ around the globe for over thirty-five years when Pastor McGregor was asked to take the helm and become the pastor of Love's Way Church; and

WHEREAS, winning a unanimous vote from the board of elders and the church, Pastor Johan McGregor became the senior pastor of Love's Way Church on August 24, 2014; the McGregors both have a deep passion to reconcile the lost back to the Father, to lead people into an ever growing relationship with Jesus Christ, and to see people transformed, equipped, and empowered to be all that God has created them to be; and

WHEREAS, Love's Way Church experienced rapid growth, and soon the chapel became overcrowded. On August 14, 2015, the church purchased a larger building located at 310 Coles Ferry Pike in Lebanon but, once again, soon found that they had outgrown their facility, a clear reflection of the momentum and impact of the Lord moving in the community; and

WHEREAS, in response to this sustained growth, Love's Way Church acquired land in 2021 and began building a larger facility in 2025 to further advance the kingdom of God and serve the city of Lebanon and the world for generations to come; and

WHEREAS, on May 3, 2026, Love's Way Church will celebrate the grand opening of their new location with the members of the congregation and the good people of Lebanon and Wilson County; and

WHEREAS, Love's Way Church is truly one of the great religious institutions and catalysts for positive spiritual change in our State and nation, and the members of this exceptional congregation should be appropriately honored for their exemplary service to their fellow Christians and the good people of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the members of Love's Way Church on the celebration of the grand opening of a new location, thank the good people of this congregation and their ministers for their notable service to their Lord and the State of Tennessee, and wish them much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.